those elections have always been won by the party in power at the time the election took place. Elections do not simply occur; they are "made".

Iran, the third of the great States of the Middle East, lies as completely outside the fold of Arab sympathies as does Turkey and only less completely outside the fold of Islam. But Iran's social, economic and political conditions are not greatly different from those of the Arab States. She has the same combination of mass poverty and illiteracy at the base, with authoritarian government at the top. The traditional Persian sect of Islam, the Shiah, is regarded as heretical by the great majority of the Islamic world. Modern Persian "heresy", however, goes farther; under Shah Riza Pahlevi, it broke the power of the religious orders in the State and turned its attention to the country's pre-Islamic tradition. The change of the name of the State from Persia to Iran was in keeping with this nationalist trend -- involving the reversal of an "innovation" that had prevailed only since the sixth century before Christ.

Militant Iranianism did not, however, serve to shake the country's extreme economic backwardness. One-third of the 15 million (or more) people of the country are still primitive nomads. The country's greatest wealth that has not been alienated by foreign concessions consists of about 16 million sheep, 6 million goats, 1 million oxen, and 1 million cows. Under the aegis of the Anglo-Iranian Oil Company, Iran has become the fourth largest crude petroleum producer in the world; in 1943, her output was 10,900,000 metric tons, compared with 4,000,000 for Iraq.

Like the upper classes of other Middle Eastern countries, the governing circle of Iran was greatly impressed with National Socialism. After the pro-German coup in Iraq in April 1941 and the German invasion of Russia in June, Russia and Britain became profoundly concerned over pro-German activities in Iran. In September 1941, the pro-German Shah was forced to abdicate. Russia and Britain jointly occupied the country. In view of its backwardness, anything that can honestly be called democratic government is im-